# MORNING BRIEFING — SATURDAY 8 AUGUST 2026

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**Weekend edition. European, US and Asian markets are all closed Saturday and Sunday. Next trading day: Monday 10 August 2026. All closing levels below are Friday 7 August 2026 unless stated otherwise; futures levels for Monday's open were not available at data-collection time.**

## 2. IMPORTANT NEWS

### Shock July US jobs report: payrolls fall 23,000 vs +80,000 expected, with 103,000 of downward revisions

Bloomberg / BLS / Quartz • Fri 7 Aug

Nonfarm payrolls unexpectedly fell 23,000 in July against a consensus gain of roughly 80,000, and May-June prints were revised down a combined 103,000. The unemployment rate printed 4.1%, though sources disagree on the direction of the move (some describe a decline from June, others a rise) — treat the direction as unconfirmed, the level as reliable. Markets read this as reducing the odds the Fed will need to keep hiking, the dominant driver of Friday's rally and the single biggest input into Monday's open.

### S&P 500 and Nasdaq close at fresh records; best week since April

CNBC / AP-Washington Post / TheStreet • Fri 7 Aug

S&P 500 +0.62% to a record 7,757.64; Nasdaq Composite +1.3% to a record 26,690.62; Dow +0.28% to 54,036.93. Weekly gains: S&P +3.6%, Nasdaq +5.2% — the strongest week for both since mid-April. Confirms broad risk-on momentum heading into Monday; record closes raise the bar for follow-through.

### September Fed hike odds tumble on the jobs miss

CNBC / Reuters • Fri 7 Aug

Rate-futures pricing for a September Fed hike fell from roughly 57-58% to roughly 42-44%; Kalshi prediction markets showed around 65% odds of a hold. Note this cycle's Fed has carried a tightening bias on tariff-driven inflation, so this is a story of hike odds falling, not cut odds rising — a nuance worth keeping straight through Monday's session.

### Gold pushes toward record territory, dollar posts worst week in three months

CNBC / Fortune / TradingEconomics • Fri 7 Aug

Gold rose to roughly $4,350/oz (+2.6% on the day) as the weak jobs print reinforced Fed rate-hold expectations; DXY fell to roughly 99.5, its worst week in three months. EUR/USD touched a seven-week high above 1.156. A weaker dollar and firmer gold both carry directly into Monday's FX and rates open.

### Strait of Hormuz tension escalates over the weekend; Saudi warns of imminent coordinated attacks

CNN / Middle East Eye / Republic World — Fri-Sat 7-8 Aug

Houthis claimed an eighth Saudi-tanker strike (the NCC Wafa) in the Gulf of Aden, and Saudi officials warned of imminent coordinated attacks on energy infrastructure, ports and airports from Iraqi militias and the Houthis. Trump separately said a US-Iran-Oman deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz could be close. Unverified weekend reports (low-reliability aggregator only, not corroborated by major wires as of data collection) describe a further tanker/drone incident near Oman and Kuwait intercepting Iranian drones on 8 August — flagged here as unconfirmed and requiring Monday-morning verification. Oil and gold remain highly sensitive to any escalation or de-escalation over the weekend.

### 3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

| CONTRACT | LEVEL | IMPLIED MOVE | COLLECTION TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| Euro Stoxx 50 futures | n/a — no weekend reopen data available | European index futures do not trade over the weekend; last reference is Friday cash close | 05:00-06:20 BST |
| DAX futures | n/a — no weekend reopen data available | See Friday DAX cash close, Section 4 | 05:00-06:20 BST |
| CAC 40 futures | n/a — no weekend reopen data available | See Friday CAC 40 cash close, Section 4 | 05:00-06:20 BST |
| FTSE 100 futures | n/a — no weekend reopen data available | See Friday FTSE cash close, Section 4 | 05:00-06:20 BST |
| US context — futures reopen Sunday evening ET | | | |
| S&P 500 e-mini | n/a — not yet reopened at data-collection time | US futures reopen Sunday ~18:00 ET (23:00 BST); no confirmed level found for this specific weekend | 05:00-06:20 BST |
| Nasdaq 100 e-mini | n/a — not yet reopened at data-collection time | Same as above | 05:00-06:20 BST |

No genuine Monday pre-open futures levels exist yet at this weekend collection time — European cash futures do not trade Saturday/Sunday and US e-minis had not yet reopened for Sunday evening at the point of writing. This section will only carry real data once futures resume; recommend checking a live terminal or CME/Investing.com futures pages directly after the Sunday 18:00 ET (23:00 BST) US reopen. Directionally, Friday's record US closes, falling September Fed-hike odds, and a weaker dollar are all consistent with a firmer bias heading into Monday, but this is inference from Friday's session, not a confirmed futures print.

## 4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRIDAY 7 AUGUST 2026)

| INDEX | CLOSE | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|
| Euro Stoxx 50 | 6,523.86 | **+0.33%** |
| STOXX 600 (pan-European, context) | 660.25 (record close) | **+0.3% — 4th consecutive record close** |
| DAX 40 | 26,319 | **+0.69% (+179 pts) — fresh record high** |
| CAC 40 | n/a — sources conflict on exact close | Reported variously +0.2% to +0.38% across sources; direction (higher) is the one consistent read |
| FTSE 100 | n/a — sources conflict | One source: +0.39% to ~10,910. Another: intraday record high 10,989.45, then closed lower at 10,868.05 (roughly flat to slightly down on the day, +1.2% on the week). Direction of the daily close is genuinely unresolved |

Continental Europe closed the week firmly higher, with the STOXX 600 notching its fourth consecutive record close and the DAX hitting a fresh all-time high, both lifted by the weak US jobs print reducing Fed-hike odds. DAX and Euro Stoxx 50 figures above are reasonably well corroborated; CAC 40 and FTSE 100 exact closing levels could not be reliably confirmed — one source describes the FTSE pulling back from an intraday record high to close roughly flat-to-lower on the day despite a strong week (+1.2%). Treat both as directionally positive-to-flat pending live-terminal confirmation.

## 5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (FRIDAY 7 AUGUST 2026)

| INDEX | CLOSE | CHANGE | NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|
| S&P 500 | 7,757.64 | **+0.62% (+47.68 pts)** | Record close; +3.6% on the week |
| Dow Jones Industrial Average | 54,036.93 | **+0.28% (+151.83 pts)** | — |
| Nasdaq Composite | 26,690.62 | **+1.3% (+342.26 pts)** | Record close; +5.2% on the week |
| Russell 2000 (context) | 3,034.49 | **+1.1% (+32.95 pts)** | Small-caps outperformed |

Corroborated across three independent outlets (AP/Washington Post, TheStreet, CNBC). A fourth source (vittarthi.com) showed materially different closes and is treated as an outlier/stale snapshot rather than used. Wall Street logged its strongest week since mid-April on a "bad news is good news" read of Friday's weak jobs report. **Leading sectors:** rate-sensitive and defensive groups — homebuilders, mortgage-related names, high-dividend payers (utilities, REITs, telecom) — plus technology and materials/mining. **Lagging sectors:** energy and financials, both modestly weaker. **Notable movers:** Coherent Corp (COHR) +43.5% over five sessions on peer results and a JPMorgan price-target hike to $435; Atlassian (TEAM) surged roughly 30-35% on a blowout Q4 (profit $139m vs a $24m loss a year earlier, cloud revenue +31% YoY), with co-founder Mike Cannon-Brookes buying up to $250m more stock.

**Key takeaway:** A surprisingly weak July jobs report reignited hopes the Fed will hold off on further hikes, sending the S&P and Nasdaq to fresh records and capping the best week since mid-April — but the report's downward revisions (103,000) also raise genuine questions about underlying labour-market strength heading into next week's data.

## 6. ASIAN MARKETS — LAST SESSION (FRIDAY 7 AUGUST 2026)

| INDEX | CLOSE | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|
| Nikkei 225 | 65,606.71 | **−0.12% (−76.55 pts)** |
| Hang Seng | 25,668.03 | **+0.54% (+137.75 pts)** |
| Shanghai Composite | 3,940.04 | **+1.02% (+39.69 pts)** |
| Kospi (South Korea) | 6,258.77 | **−0.60% (−37.61 pts)** |

Asia is closed over the weekend; Friday was the region's last completed session and Monday's Asian open (Sunday night/Monday morning UK time) will be the next available read, ahead of the European open. Friday itself was mixed: China (Shanghai +1.02%) and Hong Kong (Hang Seng +0.54%) led gains on bargain-hunting and resilient earnings, while Japan and South Korea slipped on tech/semiconductor profit-taking ahead of the US jobs release — SK Hynix fell nearly 5% in Seoul. With the jobs report now out and read as dovish for the Fed, watch whether Monday's Asian session extends Friday's tech weakness or reverses it; direct read-through risk for European semiconductor names (ASML, Infineon, STMicroelectronics) either way.

## 7. COMMODITIES

| COMMODITY | LEVEL | CHANGE | TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brent (ICE, USD/bbl) | ~$82-83 (source range $82.15-$86) | Mixed reads: one reference shows −0.41% to ~$82.15; another shows +0.97% to ~$83.29 with an intraday spike toward $86 on Hormuz-tension headlines | Fri 7 Aug |
| WTI (NYMEX, USD/bbl) | ~$78.1 | **~+1% d/d; building on prior-session gains on renewed Strait of Hormuz shipping-risk concern** | Fri 7 Aug |
| Gold (XAU/USD, USD/oz) | ~$4,350 | **+2.61% d/d; pushing toward record territory** | Fri 7 Aug |
| Natural gas (Henry Hub, USD/MMBtu) | n/a for 7 Aug; ~$2.6-2.8 as of end-July | Sharp July decline from ~$3.22-3.35 on record production and softer LNG feedgas demand | End-Jul 2026 (stale) |
| Natural gas (European TTF, EUR/MWh) | ~€52-54 | **~−2.6% d/d (source range €52.14-€54.33)** | Fri 7 Aug |
| Copper (COMEX, USD/lb / LME, USD/tonne) | ~$6.56-6.66/lb / $13,411/MT (LME) | **Pulling back from an all-time high near $6.90/lb set 6 Aug on US-China supply-squeeze dynamics** | Fri 7 Aug |

Oil stayed bid into the weekend on renewed Strait of Hormuz risk — a fresh Houthi tanker-strike claim and Saudi warnings of imminent coordinated attacks on energy infrastructure — though source figures for Brent's exact Friday level disagree materially (a $4/bbl spread between references); treat the level as fluid pending Monday confirmation. Gold continued its push toward record highs as the weak jobs print reinforced Fed-hold expectations. Copper eased from Thursday's all-time high but remains historically elevated on US-China supply dynamics. European TTF gas eased on the day but remains well above year-ago levels given ongoing Mideast-linked LNG disruption risk.

## 8. RATES & FX

| INSTRUMENT | LEVEL | CHANGE | TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| US Treasury 10-year | ~4.60% | **Fell ~7bp from ~4.67% pre-jobs-report** | Fri 7 Aug |
| German Bund 10-year | ~3.14% | **+~2bp** | Fri 7 Aug |
| EUR/USD | >1.157 (7-week high 1.1567) | **Dollar weakened sharply post-jobs-report** | Fri 7 Aug |
| GBP/USD | 1.3478 | **+0.17%** | Fri 7 Aug |
| DXY (Dollar Index) | ~99.5 | **−0.3% to −0.45%; worst week in three months** | Fri 7 Aug |

The dollar had its worst week in three months as the weak jobs report cut September Fed hike odds roughly in half, pulling the 10-year Treasury yield down and pushing EUR/USD to a seven-week high. The Bund yield firmed modestly, keeping the US-German spread compressed versus recent levels. All figures are Friday closes; no genuine Monday pre-open prints exist yet at weekend collection time — re-verify against a live terminal before the 08:00 BST cash open.

## 9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

### RECENT ISSUANCES (WEEK OF 3-7 AUGUST 2026)

| ISSUER | CURRENCY | SIZE | MATURITY | COUPON/SPREAD | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AT&T Inc. | EUR + GBP (5-part) | Conflicting: €2bn vs €4.1bn reported across sources, plus £550m sterling tranche | 4/8/12/19-year EUR + 26-year GBP | IPT only: 4yr ~ms+95bp area, 19yr ~ms+200bp area. Final priced spreads/ coupons not confirmed via open sources | Books opened 27 Jul, priced ~3 Aug. Rare large "reverse Yankee" print described as stirring the typically quiet summer market |

No other EUR-denominated corporate IG, HY, SSA or financials deal could be confirmed as pricing in the 3-7 August window via open sources — consistent with the seasonal August lull. GlobalCapital headlines note euro corporate new-issue concessions climbed to a 2026 high in July (exact bp figure paywalled) and that banks are "leaving it to corporate issuers" to reopen the credit primary market, but no further deal-level detail was accessible.

### PIPELINE / EXPECTED WEEK OF 10 AUGUST

No mandated or rumoured deal was found for the week of 10 August via open search. Market commentary (LBBW fixed income research, GlobalCapital) points to a substantive primary reopening more likely in September than early-to-mid August — Q3 net euro government/SSA supply is projected up roughly 5% to just under €110bn, with about half of that increase concentrated in September specifically. Isolated opportunistic prints (in the style of AT&T's) cannot be ruled out, but no specific issuer is confirmed as mandated or roadshowing for Monday.

### KEY SPREADS

| INDEX | LEVEL | MOVE / DIRECTION | AS OF |
|---|---|---|---|
| iTraxx Europe Main 5yr | n/a — not found via open sources | — | — |
| iTraxx Europe Crossover 5yr | ~315-320bp (STALE — mid-May reference, Series 45 traded 318bp) | Tightened from 410bp (Oct 2025) but ~80bp wider than 2024 lows; no August-dated level found | Mid-May 2026 |
| CDX IG 5yr (USD) | n/a — not found via open sources | CDX.NA.HY 5yr context only: 358bp (mid-May, stale) | — |
| Avg euro corporate IG spread (OAS proxy) | ~77-81bp (STALE) | Described as "fully valued"; no August-dated figure found | Early Jul / Q2 2026 |
| Euro HY (ICE BofA ex-fin, context) | Yield 5.66%, spread 296bp (STALE) | — | Early Jul 2026 |

No current-week (4-8 August) iTraxx Main, Crossover, CDX IG or euro OAS level could be sourced via open web access — Bloomberg, GlobalCapital, cbonds and FRED pages were paywalled or blocked to direct fetch this session. All spread figures above are 1-3 months stale and should not be presented as current; a live terminal is required for same-day confirmation before Monday's open.

COMMENTARY

Euro primary remains in its quietest, most seasonal stretch, with essentially one large opportunistic corporate (AT&T) crossing the market against an otherwise empty week — consistent with trade-press framing of early August as an intentional pause. GlobalCapital separately reports euro corporate new-issue concessions climbed to a 2026 high in July, a sign issuers are paying up more than earlier in the year even in thin volume, and flags rate volatility as clouding investor appetite for long-dated euro corporate paper. Reverse Yankee issuance (US corporates tapping EUR/GBP funding on a persistent cost advantage) remains the standout structural 2026 theme. FIG/bank issuance stayed on the sidelines this week, with corporates left to lead any reopening; SSA issuers are described as aware of a growing post-summer funding task, weighted toward September. No sector skew toward industrials, transport or energy could be established given the lack of confirmed prints this week. Recommend a live IFR/GlobalCapital and Bloomberg spread check before Monday's open.

## 10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR (MONDAY 10 AUGUST 2026)

| TIME (BST) | REGION | INDICATOR | CONSENSUS | IMPORTANCE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ~15:00 | US | Conference Board Employment Trends Index (July) | No consensus published; prior (June) 106.69, down from 106.90 — second straight monthly decline | LOW |

No high-importance Eurozone or UK release, and no named ECB/BoE/Fed speaker event, could be confirmed for Monday 10 August specifically. This is a genuinely thin calendar day.

Monday itself is quiet by design ahead of a busier week: **Tuesday 11 Aug** brings the RBA rate decision; **Wednesday 12 Aug** brings German final HICP (July) and US CPI (July, high importance — flagged by aggregators as the week's key event, consensus n/a); **Thursday 13 Aug** brings UK Q2 GDP (high importance, date provisional) and US PPI (July); **Friday 14 Aug** brings US Retail Sales (July) and the University of Michigan consumer sentiment survey. With September Fed-hike odds already repriced sharply lower on Friday's jobs miss, Wednesday's US CPI print is shaping up as the week's dominant single catalyst.

## 11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS (MONDAY 10 AUGUST 2026)

| COMPANY | MARKET | EVENT | TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| Barrick Mining Corp (NYSE/ TSX: B/ABX) | US/ Canada | Q2 2026 results; consensus revenue ~$4,487.7m (+21.9% YoY), EPS $1.16 (cut 10.15% over the past 30 days) | Before market open |
| Ferguson Enterprises Inc (NYSE: FERG) | US | Q2 2026 results; FY2026 consensus EPS $11.11, revenue $32.59bn (quarter-specific consensus n/a) | Before open; call 8:30am ET |
| Simon Property Group (NYSE: SPG) | US | Q2 2026 results; consensus EPS ~$3.18 (+4.3% YoY), revenue ~$1.71bn (+14.4% YoY) | After US close |
| Rocket Lab Corp (NASDAQ: RKLB) | US | Q2 2026 results; consensus revenue ~$231.6m (+~60% YoY), EPS loss of $0.06 (improved from −$0.13 prior year) | After US close |

Monday's confirmed slate is US-led and relatively light on European large-caps. Aggregator estimates suggest roughly 140 US companies report Monday overall, but only the four above had confirmed timing and consensus figures via open sources. AstraZeneca and GSK, mentioned in some week-ahead summaries, in fact already reported H1/Q2 results on 27 and 28 July respectively and are not reporting this week; TUI's next report (Q3) is expected Wednesday 12 August, not Monday. Later in the week, CNBC's outlook flags Super Micro Computer, Lumentum and Cardinal Health (Tuesday) and Applied Materials and Tapestry (Thursday) as other names to watch.

## 12. STOCKS TO WATCH — MONDAY 10 AUGUST

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Barrick Mining (NYSE/TSX: B/ABX) — Metals & Mining** | Reports Q2 results before Monday's open. Revenue consensus up ~22% YoY, but EPS estimate ($1.16) was cut 10% over the past 30 days — sets up genuine beat/miss swing risk. | **Event-risk, two-sided** |
| **Glencore (LSE: GLEN) / Rio Tinto (LSE: RIO) — Metals & Mining, M&A** | The six-month UK takeover-rules standstill that followed Rio Tinto's walk-away from ~$260bn merger talks (5 Feb 2026) expired around 4 August. Rio has signalled "no rush" to revive talks, but the lapsed standstill keeps deal speculation live into the new week. | **Event-risk, headline-sensitive** |
| **Rocket Lab (NASDAQ: RKLB) — Aerospace / Space** | Reports after Monday's close; options market pricing a roughly 15-17% post-earnings share move. Strong Buy consensus heading in (14 buy, 4 hold). | **Event-risk, bullish positioning** |
| **Frontline (NYSE/Oslo: FRO) / tanker names — Shipping** | Renewed Strait of Hormuz tension over the weekend (fresh tanker-strike claims, Saudi warnings of imminent attacks) is a fresh security-risk premium for crude/product tankers; Frontline has also seen recent price-target increases on strong tanker-market performance. | **Bullish bias on freight/ geopolitical premium** |
| **BAE Systems (LSE: BA.) / Rolls-Royce (LSE: RR.) — Aerospace & Defense** | BAE hiked FY2026 underlying-earnings growth guidance to 10-12% after H1 underlying earnings jumped 46% to £2.53bn; both names running on NATO/defence-spending tailwinds and, for Rolls-Royce, data-centre power-systems demand. No confirmed Monday-specific catalyst — momentum watch, not a hard trigger. | **Bullish momentum** |
| **IAG (LSE: IAG) / easyJet (LSE: EZJ) — Aviation** | IATA cut its 2026 global airline profit forecast to $23bn from $45bn on Middle East-linked fuel-cost pressure; JPMorgan named IAG its top sector pick while turning negative on easyJet on intra-European short-haul oversupply concerns. Weekend oil-price moves tied to Hormuz risk are a direct jet-fuel read-through into Monday. | **Mixed — IAG bullish bias, easyJet bearish bias** |
| **HSBC (LSE: HSBA) / Barclays (LSE: BARC) — Banks** | Not reporting Monday, but both remain in focus after a record run. HSBC hit a record high on capital-return optimism even as BNP Paribas cut it to Underperform on 4 August; Barclays is up 43.9% over six months versus HSBC's 33.6%, both outpacing the sector's ~26% rally. | **Momentum names, watch for profit-taking** |
| **Ferguson Enterprises (NYSE: FERG) — Industrials** | Reports before Monday's open. FY2026 consensus EPS $11.11 / revenue $32.59bn cited by aggregators, but no quarter-specific figure found — genuine event-risk into the print. | **Event-risk** |

## 13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

### MACRO

**July payrolls shock:** nonfarm payrolls fell 23,000 versus a roughly +80,000 consensus, with a combined 103,000 of downward revisions to May and June. Unemployment printed 4.1%, though sources disagree on whether that was up or down versus June — a genuine unresolved data point. This single report reshaped Fed pricing for the week ahead.

**September Fed hike odds roughly halved:** from the high-50s% to the low-40s%, on a Fed that has been running a tightening bias this cycle on tariff-driven inflation. Kalshi markets put hold odds around 65%.

**ECB holding, but flagging a possible September hike:** the ECB kept its main rate at 2.25% in late July, with traders pricing a possible September hike given an energy-price spike linked to the Iran conflict and inflation seen staying above target into H1 2027 — a hawkish-leaning ECB set against a softening Fed narrative is a live policy-divergence theme into Monday's European open.

**US CPI (Wednesday 12 Aug)** is now the week's dominant single catalyst, given how sharply Friday's jobs data already moved rate expectations.

### CORPORATE

**Atlassian (TEAM)** surged roughly 30-35% on a blowout Q4: $139m profit versus a $24m loss a year earlier, cloud revenue +31% YoY, with co-founder Mike Cannon-Brookes buying up to $250m more stock.

**Coherent Corp (COHR)** rose 43.5% over five sessions on peer results, reports of tighter US restrictions on Chinese optical transceivers, and a JPMorgan price-target hike to $435.

**Chip-sector strength** has been a repeated theme through the week (Intel, AMD, Broadcom, Nvidia all higher around the 4 August reporting window), feeding into Friday's Nasdaq record, though Friday itself saw Asian chip names (SK Hynix) pull back on profit-taking.

**Rio Tinto/Glencore** standstill agreement lapsed around 4 August; Rio has signalled no rush to revive merger talks, but headline risk remains live into the new week.

### POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

**Strait of Hormuz:** the US-Israel-Iran conflict, ongoing since 28 February 2026, remains the dominant tail risk. Trump said a US-Iran-Oman deal to reopen the strait could come "pretty soon," while Houthis claimed an eighth Saudi-tanker strike and Saudi officials warned of imminent coordinated attacks on energy infrastructure, ports and airports from Iraqi militias and the Houthis. Neither the reopening deal nor the specific weekend escalation reports (a further tanker/drone incident, Kuwait intercepting Iranian drones) are confirmed by major financial wires as of data collection — both need Monday-morning verification.

**US-China tariffs:** a new 12.5% Section 301 tariff on Chinese goods took effect 24 July over forced-labour enforcement; the broader tariff truce runs to 10 November 2026, so there is no imminent August deadline, though a Section 301 "excess capacity" investigation into 60 countries remains an open overhang.

## 14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

### TODAY'S TOP 5 (MONDAY 10 AUGUST)

**1. Whether Friday's rally carries into Monday**

Record US and European closes Friday, plus lower Fed hike odds, set a firmer bias — but no confirmed futures print exists yet to validate it.

**2. Strait of Hormuz weekend developments**

Unconfirmed weekend escalation reports need verification; any confirmation or de-escalation is the single biggest swing factor for oil and gold at the open.

**3. Barrick Mining and Ferguson earnings, before the open**

Two names with cut or unconfirmed consensus estimates, setting up genuine event-risk into Monday's session.

**4. Asian session read-through**

Whether Friday's chip-sector weakness in Japan/Korea extends or reverses on Monday's Asian open, ahead of Europe.

**5. Positioning ahead of Wednesday's US CPI**

With Fed pricing already sharply repriced by Friday's jobs miss, Monday's flows likely reflect early positioning for the week's dominant data point.

### THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

**1. US CPI, Wednesday 12 August**

The week's dominant single catalyst for rate expectations, sharpened by Friday's payrolls shock.

**2. UK Q2 GDP, Thursday 13 August**

High-importance UK growth data (date provisional), alongside US PPI the same day.

**3. Rocket Lab, Simon Property earnings (Monday) plus a heavy US reporting week**

Around 140 US names reporting Monday alone; Super Micro, Lumentum, Cardinal Health (Tue) and Applied Materials, Tapestry (Thu) also flagged.

**4. Strait of Hormuz negotiation trajectory**

The single biggest swing factor for oil, gold, aviation and defence stocks all week.

**5. Rio Tinto/Glencore standstill expiry aftermath**

Headline risk on renewed M&A speculation remains live after the standstill lapsed.

### THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

**1. Euro DCM primary market reopening, expected September**

Market commentary points to a substantive reopening after Labor Day rather than within August; Q3 SSA supply weighted toward September.

**2. Next ECB decision, expected 10 September**

Traders are pricing a possible hike on energy-driven inflation from the Iran conflict — a hawkish ECB against a softening Fed is a live divergence theme.

**3. Strait of Hormuz risk remains the dominant tail risk**

Any breakdown in the reported reopening deal, or confirmation of further attacks, could re-ignite oil and gold volatility through the month.

**4. Next FOMC meeting**

Following Friday's payrolls shock and the sharp repricing of September hike odds, positioning builds through August into the meeting.

**5. US-China tariff truce, expires 10 November**

No imminent August deadline, but the open Section 301 "excess capacity" investigation into 60 countries remains a background overhang.

## 15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

### 1 DAY

**Confirmation of Monday's futures:** no genuine pre-open levels exist yet at this weekend writing time — check live futures shortly after the Sunday 18:00 ET US reopen.

**Strait of Hormuz weekend claims:** unconfirmed reports of a further tanker/drone incident need verification against major wires before Monday's open.

**Barrick Mining and Ferguson earnings** before the US open, plus Rocket Lab and Simon Property after the close.

**Asian session read-through** on chip-sector direction ahead of the European open.

### 1 WEEK

**Wednesday 12 Aug:** US CPI, the week's dominant single event for rate expectations.

**Thursday 13 Aug:** UK Q2 GDP and US PPI.

**Friday 14 Aug:** US retail sales and University of Michigan sentiment.

**Ongoing:** Strait of Hormuz negotiation trajectory, and whether the September Fed-hike repricing holds through the week.

### 1 MONTH

**Expected September:** euro DCM primary market reopening after the current lull, and the next ECB decision (10 Sept), where traders are pricing a possible hike on energy-driven inflation.

**Ongoing:** Strait of Hormuz risk remains the dominant macro tail risk through the month; Reverse Yankee euro/sterling issuance pace continues as a structural theme.

**10 November:** US-China tariff truce expiry, with a live Section 301 "excess capacity" investigation into 60 countries running in the background.

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- Mining Weekly / MINING.COM — Rio Tinto/Glencore standstill expiry
- Yahoo Finance UK / Kalkine Media / ii.co.uk — aviation and defence sector stocks to watch
- Bloomberg (via search summary) / Yahoo Finance — HSBC and Barclays bank-sector context
- European Central Bank / Bank of England / Federal Reserve — policy meeting dates and context

> Weekend edition. Data collected automatically between approximately 05:00 and 06:20 BST on 8 August 2026 via open web search. Direct WebFetch access to many primary sources (Bloomberg, GlobalCapital, IFR, cbonds, TradingEconomics, several news aggregators) was blocked throughout this session; figures come from search-engine snippet summaries rather than direct page reads. No genuine Monday pre-open futures data exists at this writing time — European futures do not trade over the weekend and US e-minis had not yet reopened for Sunday evening. CAC 40 and FTSE 100 Friday closing levels, exact Brent crude pricing, the direction of the July unemployment-rate move, and current-week DCM spread levels are all flagged as unconfirmed or conflicting above and should be re-verified before use. Two central weekend claims — further Hormuz-area tanker/drone incidents on 8 August — are sourced only from a low-reliability aggregator and are not confirmed by major financial wires. Verify all figures against a live terminal before making any decision. This document is not investment advice.